MR. MULKEY'S 5:00 SECOND GRADE KIDSTUFF CLASS HANDBOOK 2017-2018

INTRODUCTION

Dear Second Grade Parent,

My name is Jonathan Mulkey, and I am so excited to be your child's Kidstuff teacher at 5:00 this year! I have been with North Hill's children's ministry since 2006 and have taught second graders every year.

My class is highly structured around a U.S. Army theme. I borrowed and adapted this theme from my dad, a retired Army major and Sunday school teacher. Students can earn promotions through the ranks as they accumulate points. They earn points by completing two weekly "missions":

Mission 1: Complete Activity Sheet (3 points)
Each Sunday, a two-sided activity sheet is sent home with students. Students complete this sheet during the week and turn it in the next Sunday. The sheet must be completely and neatly done for full credit (students will be given the opportunity to redo or complete if this is not the case).

Mission 2: Recite Memory Verse (3 points)
Stapled to each activity sheet is a memory verse. Students memorize this verse during the week and recite it the next Sunday. A few verses throughout the year may be worth more than 3 points based on length/difficulty. The verse must be said completely and correctly with no more than a one-word prompt allowed for full credit (students will be given the opportunity to recite again if this is not the case).

Absences
If your child is absent from class, they can still complete their missions and you can send the completed missions to me by email or phone at jhmulkey@gmail.com or (864) 569-4879. Simply scan or take a photo of each page of their completed activity sheet and record an audio or video clip of them reciting their memory verse. All missions are made available on the class website: jhmulkey.wixsite.com/ksgrade2

Late Missions
In order to be fair to students who are diligently completing their missions each week, 1 point will be subtracted from any missions completed more than three weeks after the assigned date, and an additional 1 point will be subtracted from any missions completed more than six weeks after the assigned date. So, it is not worth it for students to procrastinate and then complete a bunch of missions at once, as they will only be able to earn a fraction of the points. Slow and steady wins the race!

Bonus Missions
At least once each quarter, I will assign a "bonus mission" that students can complete for extra points.

Weekly Prize Drawing
In addition to prizes earned with promotions, each week I will draw one name at random, and if that student is in class, they will get to choose a prize from the prize drawer at the end of class. Any single student may only win the drawing once each quarter. Just another reason to attend class ☺

U.S. ARMY THEME

Ranks
Each student starts out as a new recruit. Each promotion requires 10 points. All the ranks and required points are shown at the very end of this handbook.

Promotions
Each week students who have earned enough points for promotion will receive their new rank badge and get to choose a prize from the prize drawer at the end of class! Please note that points earned from missions turned in on Sunday are processed after class and thus count towards the next week's promotions, not the current week's.

Becoming an Officer
Students who reach the first "officer" rank (2nd Lieutenant) will receive a special certificate.

Becoming a General
Students who reach the first "general" rank (Brigadier General) will receive yet another special certificate and a special prize.

General of the Army
Students who earn this rank have demonstrated an amazing level of hard work and dedication. On the last day of class, they will not only receive a very special framed certificate, but several other special prizes. Students who want to attain this rank will need to get serious about class right away in order to earn the necessary 200 points.

Prizes
This is a big deal for the kids, and any small prize donations you can make to the prize drawer would be greatly appreciated. Please no food or candy, though!

Sergeant Tank
Sergeant Tank is an animated dog I created in PowerPoint that helps us work on our memory verse each week. He uses his tank (or other vehicles) and various weapons to destroy different words from the verse so we have to recite it each time filling in the missing words from memory. You will likely hear your child talking about Tank, so I want you to know who he is ☺

Please Note!
Please note that this Army theme and point structure apply only to my class (5:00). I strongly urge parents to do their best to stick to one service time if at all possible. Students who attend Kidstuff sporadically or frequently switch service times lose the continuity of having the same teacher each week and being accustomed to the class procedures. Consistency is a huge help for learning, especially at this age.

CURRICULUM

Bible Lessons
In second grade, students spend three academic quarters studying the gospel of John. Our prayer through this study is that your child will grow in both their knowledge and love for the incarnate Son of God. During the fourth academic quarter, we study the Armor of God from Ephesians 6, and we'll

learn how to live like Jesus taught us by using the spiritual armor God has provided us. The following is a summary of what we'll be learning each quarter:

Quarters 1-3: *The Gospel of John*
We learn about the person and work of Jesus as He ministers and preaches in Galilee, Judea, Samaria, and beyond. We will highlight the seven signs He performed that point to His deity. Our main focus throughout will be on the vital importance of a personal relationship with Him for eternal life.

Quarter 4: *The Armor of God* (Ephesians 6)
We learn about the spiritual armor God has provided for us to live victoriously in spiritual warfare. We will make each piece of armor as a craft: the Belt of Truth, the Breastplate of Righteousness, the Shoes of the Gospel, the Shield of Faith, the Helmet of Salvation, and the Sword of the Spirit. We then conclude the year with a class party.

Memory Verses
We use the English Standard Version (ESV) in class. We memorize a different passage each quarter:

First Week: Psalm 139:17 (class verse)
Quarter 1: Philippians 2:5-11 (Jesus' Example of Humility)
Quarter 2: Matthew 5:3-12 (The Beatitudes)
Quarter 3: Romans 8:31-39 (God's Everlasting Love)
Quarter 4: Ephesians 6:10-18 (The Armor of God)

We do go over the verse in class each week and begin memory work, but students will need to continue to study the verse throughout the week. The best way to successfully memorize the weekly verse is to go over it at least once each day. Waiting until the weekend or on the way to church Sunday is never a good idea. Steady, daily practice not only aids long-term memory, but also gives students the opportunity to apply God's Word to their lives each day. In fact, your whole family may want to memorize the verse together each week.

Every once in a while, I will have a parent ask if their child may memorize the weekly verses in a different Bible translation or if they can recite verses they learn in school instead. However, in order to be fair and consistent, I do require all verses to be recited from the ESV translation and only the verses assigned in my class. I have never had a student who put forth the effort not be able to successfully memorize these verses, even if they have verses they memorize in school as well.

FINAL NOTES

Arrive on Time
Please be sure your child arrives no later than five minutes before class start time (4:55) each Sunday. This allows them enough time to complete their missions and get ready for class. If you arrive after class has started, your child will have to wait until the end of class to complete their missions.

Stay Connected!
I do my best to ensure you as parents are connected with what your child is doing and learning in class:

Website
You've already found it!

There you can download the weekly missions in case your child is absent or loses the originals.

Weekly Email Update
Every week, I will send out an email with a summary of what we learned that week, announcements, student point status, and that week's missions. If you aren't getting this email, let me know so I can add you to the email list.

Contact
Feel free to contact me at any time via phone, text, or email. There is also a contact form on my website.

In Conclusion…
Our goal in Kidstuff is to partner with you, the parents, in training your child in the Word of God. I use an army theme in my class not only because it is fun for the kids, but also because it is a good analogy to the Christian's life. Life is a battle between God's truth and Satan's lies. We need to take God's side and submit ourselves to Him as our "Commander-in-Chief." Through our study this year, my prayer is that your child (and all of us) will come to know and love Jesus more deeply, and that what we learn will not stay stuck in our heads, but move to our hearts in praise and hands in ministry. If there is any way we can serve you, please don't hesitate to contact me.

With great excitement and prayerful hope for the year to come,

Jonathan Mulkey
2nd Grade Teacher
North Hills Church
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(see next page for list of ranks and point requirements)

Private		10
Private First Class		20
Corporal		30
Sergeant		40
Staff Sergeant		50
Sergeant First Class		60
Master Sergeant		70
Sergeant Major		80
Command Sergeant Major		90
Second Lieutenant		100
First Lieutenant		110
Captain		120
Major		130
Lieutenant Colonel		140
Colonel		150
Brigadier General		160
Major General		170
Lieutenant General		180
General		190
General of the Army		200